Holy Trinity University

Introduction to Patristic Studies

Course Outline

Instructor Information:

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Course Description

Patrology course is a survey of the literature and authors of Christian antiquity, spanning from the first Century. Through readings of primary sources, students will gain an appreciation for the diverse voices and theological perspectives of the Church Fathers. We will also explore the historical events, cultural contexts, and linguistic factors that shaped the development of Christian thought during this period.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this course, students will be able to:

- **Understand the Concept of Patrology**
  - Define patrology and identify its significance in Christian history.
- **Study the Lives and Works of Church Fathers**
  - Gain familiarity with the influential figures in early Christianity.
- **Recognize the Personalities of the Fathers**
  - Describe the concerns and biographical details relevant to the Fathers of the Church.
- **Articulate Relevance Today**
  - Explain how the fathers' teachings apply to modern catechesis and evangelism.
- **Contextual Understanding**
  - Understand the events and cultural contexts that shaped patristic thought.
- **Navigate Primary Texts**
  - Cultivate skills for interpreting and analyzing primary patristic writings.

Required Texts:

- Malaty, T. Y. (2003). Lectures in Patrology. St. George's Coptic Orthodox Church Sporting, Alexandria, Egypt.
- Tixeront, J. (1923). A Handbook of Patrology. Great Russell St., London, W.C.

Recommended Texts:

- Quasten, Johannes. *Patrology* (Vols. 1-4, Allen, TX: Christian Classics, 1995).

- Cayré, F. *Manual of Patrology* (Translated by H. Howitt, Vols. 1-2, Paris: Desclée, 1927, 1930).
- Bettenson, H. (1956). *The Early Christian Fathers*. Oxford University Press.
- Bettenson, H. (1970). *The Late Christian Fathers*. Oxford University Press.
- Drobner, H. R. (2007). *The Fathers of the Church*. Hendrickson Publishers.
- Pelikan, J. (1971, 1974). *The Christian Tradition: A History of the Development of Doctrine* (Vols. 1 & 2). University of Chicago Press.
- Daniélou, J. (1964-1977). *The Development of Christian Doctrine before the Council of Nicaea* (Vols. 1-3). Darton, Longman & Todd.
- Siejkowski, P. A. (2010). *SCM Study guide to Early Christian Doctrine and the Creeds*. SCM Press.

Course Schedule (Subject to Change):

Week	Topic	Specific Part	Remarks
1	Introduction to Patrology	Definition Qualifications for the "Father" in Patrology The Authority of the Fathers	
2	Foundations of Patristic Study	The History of Patrology Classification of Patristic Writings Outline of Patristic Literature	
3	Summary on Introduction	Meaning, History, importance and division of patrology	
4	Apostolic Fathers	Apostolic Fathers and St. Clement of Rome	
5	Mid Exam		
6-7	Apostolic Fathers	St Ignatius and St Polycarp	
8-9	Apostolic Fathers	Barnabas and the shepherd Hermas	
10	Early Apologists	Quadratus, Author of the Letter to Diognetus, Author of the Preaching of Peter	
11	Early Apologists	Minucius Felix, St. Justin the martyr	
12	Early Apologists	Athenagoras, Tatian the Syrian Miltiades	
13	Class presentation on a	1. Aristo of Pella	

	chosen Apologist	2. Didache 3. Apostolic Creed	
14	Class presentation on a chosen Apologist	1. Melito Bishop of Sardis 2. Apollinaris of Hierapolis 3. Theophilus of Antioch	
15	CELEBRATION OF EPHIPHANY		
16	FINAL EXAM		

Course Requirements:

- **Attendance:** All students are expected to attend all class lectures.
- **Readings:** Assigned readings are crucial for class discussions and should be completed before each session. Typically, you will read a short chapter from a secondary source and a primary source text by a Church Father.
- **Theological Reflections (1 page):** Prior to each class (except the first), you will submit a one-page written reflection on one of the assigned primary source readings. This reflection should analyze the text and explore its theological significance.
- **Midterm Exam :** The midterm will assess your understanding of key figures, concepts, and historical contexts covered in the first half of the course.
- **Group Assignment Paper :** You will write a research paper (5- 10 pages) on a topic related to patristics. The paper proposal is due in Week 12, and you will have the opportunity to consult with the instructor during Week 13.
- **Final Exam:** the students examine finally with the overall studies
- **Feedback:** Students are encouraged to share feedback to enhance the course experience. Feel free to communicate with the instructor at any time.